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TORRANCE CITY COUNCIL – AUGUST 11, 2026

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At 11:43 p.m., the City Council adjourned to at 11:43 p.m. to Tuesday, August 18, 2026, at 5:00 p.m. for Closed Session in the LeRoy J. Jackson Council Chamber.

Aleksander Alderete
Minutes Secretary

City Council
August 11, 2026

MINUTES OF A REGULAR MEETING
OF THE TORRANCE CITY COUNCIL

1. CALL TO ORDER

The Torrance City Council convened in a regular meeting on August 11, 2026 at 5:02 p.m. in the Leroy J. Jackson City Council Chambers at Torrance City Hall.

ROLL CALL

Present: Councilmembers Gerson, Kartsonis, Lewis, Lieu, Sheikh, and Mayor Kalani

Absent: None

Present: City Manager Chaparyan, City Attorney Sullivan, City Clerk Rebecca Poirier and other staff representatives

Agenda item 13 was considered out of order at this time.

13. CLOSED SESSION

The City Council immediately recessed to closed session at 5:04 p.m. to confer with the City Manager and the City Attorney on agenda matters listed under 13A) Conference with Legal Counsel – Existing Litigation, 13B) Real Property – Conference with Real Property Negotiator, and 13C) Conference with Labor Negotiator – Anticipated Litigation - Litigation pursuant to California Government Code §54956.9(d)(1), California Government Code §54956.8 and California Government Code §54957.6.

The City Council reconvened in public session at 6:30 p.m. No formal action was taken on any item considered in closed session.

2. FLAG SALUTE/ INVOCATION

The flag salute was led by Councilmember Lewis.

The non-sectarian invocation was given by Councilmember Lieu.

3. WITHDRAWN, DEFERRED OR SUPPLEMENTAL ITEMS

Item 8H and 8J were deferred. Supplemental material was available for items 8E, 8I, and 9A.

4. REPORT OF CITY CLERK ON POSTING OF THE AGENDA/ MOTION TO WAIVE FURTHER READING

MOTION: Councilmember Gerson moved that after the City Clerk has read aloud the number and title of any resolution or ordinance on the meeting agenda, the further reading thereof shall be waived, reserving and guaranteeing to each Councilmember the right to demand the reading of any such resolution or ordinance in regular order. The motion was seconded by Councilmember Kartsonis and passed by 6-0.

5. COUNCIL COMMITTEE MEETINGS AND ANNOUNCEMENTS

Mayor Kalani requested to adjourn the City Council in honor of Ryan Simpkins.

Councilmember Sheikh announced the August 20 beginning of the Torrance Transit program to SoFi for the upcoming NFL season. He stated that there would be promotions for the program upcoming.

Councilmember Lieu encouraged the public to contribute to the objective development standard for the Hillside Overlay and single family neighborhoods.

Councilmember Kartsonis received concurrence to have staff come with an item defining zones, buffers, scheduling, cooling fan noise, testing and emissions for datacenters.

Mayor Kalani received concurrence to have City Clerk advertise three remaining commission vacancies on Civil Services, Historic Preservation, and Parks and Recreation and bring an item back to appoint the positions.

City Clerk Poirier stated that applications were open for the district 4 seat. August 13 was the due date and applications must be submitted with the supplemental questionnaire.

Commissioners Akiyama and Safarian discussed the 2026 beautification awards.

6. COMMUNITY MATTERS

6A. APPOINT MEMBERS OF THE 2026-2027 TORRANCE YOUTH COUNCIL

MOTION: Councilmember Gerson moved to appoint the members of the 2026-2027 Torrance Youth Council. Councilmember Lewis seconded the motion. The motion carried by a vote of 6-0.

6B. PROCLAMATION DECLARING AUGUST 15, 2026 AS INDIA INDEPENDENCE DAY IN THE CITY OF TORRANCE

7. ORAL COMMUNICATIONS

Members of the public spoke.

8. CONSENT CALENDAR

8A. APPROVE CITY COUNCIL MINUTES

Recommendation of the City Clerk that City Council approve the City Council minutes of June 23, 2026.

8B. AUTHORIZE TORRANCE YOUTH COUNCIL TO CONDUCT ANNUAL WORKSHOP AT THE ATTIC, A TORRANCE TEEN CENTER

Recommendation of the Community Services Director that City Council authorize the Torrance Youth Council to conduct their annual workshop on Monday, August 17, 2026, at THE ATTIC, a Torrance Teen Center located at 2320 West Carson Street.

8C. APPROVE PROPOSED JOB DESCRIPTION FOR SENIOR MANAGEMENT ASSOCIATE

Recommendation of the Human Resources Director that City Council approve the proposed job description for Senior Management Associate.

8D. APPROVE THE TRANSIT DEPARTMENTS SUBMITTAL OF ANNUAL CLAIM FOR TRANSPORTATION DEVELOPMENT ACT AND STATE TRANSIT ASSISTANCE FUNDS FOR FISCAL YEAR 2026-27

Recommendation of the Transit Director that City Council approve the Transit Department's submittal of the annual claim to the Los Angeles County Metropolitan Transportation Authority (Metro) for $7,779,832 in Transportation Development Act funds and $1,089,017 in State Transit Assistance funds for Fiscal Year (FY) 2026-27.

8F. AUTHORIZE PURCHASE ORDER OF TWO (2) TORO GROUNDSMASTER 5910 MOWERS AS A COOPERATIVE PURCHASE WITH SOURCEWELL

Recommendation of the General Services Director and Community Services Director that City Council authorize a purchase order with Turf Star Western of Brea, CA, in the amount of $372,467.06, plus a 5% contingency in the amount of $18,623.35, for a total not-to-exceed amount of $391,090.41, for two (2) Toro Groundsmaster 5910 Mowers as a Cooperative Purchase with Sourcewell.

8G. AUTHORIZE PURCHASE ORDER FOR ONE (1) 2026 FORD F350 SERVICE TRUCK FROM KEN GRODY FORD

Recommendation of the General Services Director and Transit Director that City Council authorize a purchase order with Ken Grody Ford of Buena Park, CA, in the amount of $81,683.70, plus a 5% contingency in the amount of $4,084.19, for a total not-to-exceed amount of $85,767.89, for one (1) 2026 Ford F350 Service Truck.

8H. ITEM NUMBER NOT USED

8I. APPROVE AMENDMENTS TO MEASURE M FUNDING AGREEMENTS WITH THE LOS ANGELES COUNTY METROPOLITAN TRANSPORTATION AUTHORITY (LACMTA)

Recommendation of the Public Works Director that City Council:

1. Approve Amendment No. 4 to Measure R Funding Agreement #MOU.MR312.26 with the Los Angeles County Metropolitan Transportation Authority (LACMTA) (C2014-072) for the I-405 at 182nd Street/Crenshaw Boulevard Operational Improvements, T-155 to extend the lapse date of all Funds programmed for FY 2017-18 to June 30, 2027; and
2. Approve Amendment No. 6 to Measure R Funding Agreement #MOU.MR312.40 with LACMTA (C2014-056) for the Pacific Coast Highway at Vista Montana/Anza Avenue Intersection Improvements, T-154 to extend the lapse date of all Funds programmed for FY 2013-14 to June 30, 2027; and
3. Approve Amendment No. 7 to Measure R Funding Agreement #MOU.MR312.10 with LACMTA (C2012-035) for the Pacific Coast Highway at Hawthorne Boulevard Intersection Improvements, T-131 to extend the lapse date of all Funds programmed for FY 2014-15 to June 30, 2027; and
4. Approve Amendment No. 7 to Measure R Funding Agreement #MOU.MR312.60 with LACMTA (C2015-043) for the Crenshaw Boulevard from Del Amo Boulevard to Dominguez Street Improvements, T-157 to extend the lapse date of all Funds programmed for FY 2015-16 to June 30, 2027; and
5. Approve Amendment No. 1 to Measure R Funding Agreement #MOU.MR312.63 with LACMTA (C2020-110) for the Pacific Coast Highway at Crenshaw Boulevard Intersection Improvements, T-143 to extend the lapse date of all Funds programmed for FY 2019-20 to June 30, 2027; and
6. Approve Amendment No. 6 to Measure R Funding Agreement #MOU.MR312.23 with LACMTA (C2011-192) for the Torrance Transit Park and Ride Regional Terminal Project P4, FEAP 764 to extend the lapse date of all Funds programmed for FY 2018-19 to June 30, 2027.

8J. ADOPT CATEGORICAL EXEMPTION AND APPROVE TEN-YEAR LEASE AGREEMENT FOR TORRANCE POLICE SUBSTATION AT DEL AMO FASHION CENTER

Recommendation of the City Manager and Chief of Police that City Council:
1. Adopt a California Environmental Quality Act (CEQA) Categorical Exemption pursuant to Guideline Section 15301 (Existing Facilities); and
2. Approve lease agreement between the City of Torrance and Del Amo Fashion Center Operating Company, LLC, in the amount of $100 ($10 annually), to continue operation of the Torrance Police Substation at Del Amo Fashion Center, for a ten-year (10) term beginning September 1, 2026 and ending August 31, 2036.

Item 8J was deferred.

8K. ADOPT CATEGORICAL EXEMPTION UNDER CALIFORNIA ENVIRONMENTAL QUALITY ACT (CEQA), APPROVE LICENSE AGREEMENT FOR USE OF DEE HARDISON SPORT CENTER AT CHARLES H. WILSON PARK AND AUTHORIZE CITY MANAGER TO EXECUTE AGREEMENT

Recommendation of the City Manager and Community Services Director that City Council:
1. Adopt a California Environmental Quality Act (CEQA) Categorical Exemption pursuant to Guidelines Section 15301 (Existing Facilities); and
2. Approve a License Agreement with Ambassador High School for use of the Dee Hardison Sports Center at Charles H. Wilson Park, for a five-year (5) term, beginning August 11, 2026 and ending August 10, 2031; and
3. Authorize the City Manager to execute the agreement.

8L. APPROVE SECOND AMENDMENT TO TOLLING AGREEMENT FOR CITY-OWNED PROPERTY LOCATED AT 24777 CRENSHAW BOULEVARD AND AUTHORIZE CITY MANAGER TO EXECUTE AGREEMENT

Recommendation of the City Manager and City Attorney that City Council:
1. Approve a Second Amendment to Tolling Agreement between the City and SBL Auto, Inc, SBL Properties, LLC and The Adkins Family Trust for City-owned property located at 24777 Crenshaw Boulevard; and
2. Authorize the City Manager to execute the agreement.

MOTION: Councilmember Lewis moved to approve the Consent Calendar except 8H, 8J, and 8E. Councilmember Sheikh seconded the motion. The motion carried by a vote of 6-0.

8E. AWARD CONTRACT SERVICE AGREEMENT TO OPERATE THE TORRANCE COMMUNITY TRANSIT PROGRAM (TCTP) FOR A THREE-YEAR (3) PERIOD BEGINNING AUGUST 1, 2026 AND ENDING JULY 31, 2029

Recommendation of the Transit Director that City Council award a contract services agreement to Administrative Services Cooperative, Inc. of Torrance, CA (RFP B2026-10), in the amount of $753,426.75 annually, for a total not-to-exceed amount of $2,260,280.85, to operate the Torrance Community Transit Program (TCTP) for a three-year (3) period beginning August 1, 2026 and ending July 31, 2029.

Councilmember Sheikh thanked staff for their efforts. He requested information if any improvements could be made.

MOTION: Councilmember Sheikh moved to approve item 8E. Councilmember Kartsonis seconded the motion. The motion carried by a vote of 6-0.

9. HEARINGS

9A. CONDUCT PUBLIC HEARING TO CONSIDER APPEAL OF PLANNING COMMISSION'S DENIAL OF MINOR HILLSIDE EXEMPTION (MHE25-00051) TO ALLOW A PROPOSED 694 SQUARE FOOT ATTACHED GARAGE LOCATED ON THE NORTH SIDE OF AN EXISTING ONE-STORY SINGLE-FAMILY RESIDENCE, ON PROPERTY LOCATED WITHIN THE HILLSIDE OVERLAY (R-H) IN THE SINGLE FAMILY RESIDENTIAL DISTRICT (R-1) ZONE AT 439 VIA LINDA VISTA; (APN 7514-012-028), ADOPT RESOLUTION AND DETERMINE A CATEGORICAL EXEMPTION FROM THE CALIFORNIA ENVIRONMENTAL QUALITY ACT (CEQA)

Recommendation of the Planning Commission and Community Development Director that City Council:

1. Conduct a public hearing; and
2. Determine a Categorical Exemption for the project in accordance with Guidelines for Implementation of the California Environmental Quality Act (CEQA); Article 19, Section 15301 – Existing Facilities; and
3. Approve a Minor Hillside Exemption (MHE25-00051) for a proposed 694 square foot attached garage located on the north side of an existing one-story single-family residence, on property located within the Hillside Overlay (R-H) in the Single-Family Residential District (R-1) Zone at 439 Via Linda Vista; and
4. Adopt RESOLUTION to approve a Minor Hillside Exemption (MHE25-00051) for a proposed 694 square foot attached garage located on the north side of an existing one-story single-family residence, on property located within the Hillside Overlay (R-H) in the Single-Family Residential District (R-1) Zone at 439 Via Linda Vista.

Councilmember Kartsonis disclosed that he was on the Planning Commission during this item's decision and so he recused himself at 7:40 p.m.

Councilmember Lieu disclosed that some of the applicant's neighbors emailed all councilmembers about the proposal and she replied to one of them that she would uphold the Planning Commission's to deny the project. Due to this, she recused herself under California law at 7:42 p.m.

Councilmember Lewis, Sheikh, and Gerson disclosed that they visited the site and would make their decision based on evidence provided during the hearing.

Mayor Kalani disclosed that she visited the site and the property above one of the properties above the subject property but that she would base her decision on evidence provided during the hearing.

Planning Assistant Austin Lujan introduced the item to the City Council. He used slides to overview the project location, background, reasons for appeal, site plan, elevations, silhouette and recommendation.

The City Council went to recess at 7:49 p.m. The City Council returned from recess at 7:55 p.m.

The appellant Christine Freeze overviewed their case with background information regarding the garage and the new garage and the amount to fit inside. She recounted the exemption that was given and the ADU. She showcased photos of the property showing the hedges, garage, silhouette, and more surroundings. She overviewed the case on the roof plan given the ministerial ADU plans submitted with reviewable projects.

The opposing party, represented by Kendra Mehr, listed the resident opposition. She overviewed slides including the problems with the roof, the 10.5 ft that was reviewed and the actual 23.5 ft that will actually be built, and more. She continued that California law showed that under the terms of air, light, privacy, views and more would be harmed due to the project. She stated that they were not asking to deny the ADU and not subjected to discretionary review. She added that ADUs were allowed while still making findings about the complete structure. She mentioned the consequences of allowing this would damage the Hillside. She reiterated to deny the appeal and re-evaluate it, but that if the Council had no other way but to deny then they requested to continue the matter and direct staff to analyze the real complete project.

Michael Wachtfogel, an appellant, described his story about the impact of the project and how it could be reduced. He continued that the project's proponent's own architects proposed changes would cause him to lose his view from the project, and Mr. Wachtfogel stated that was not his decision to make. He stated that the proponent's owner has made no tries to make contact.

Jennifer Adams, a resident, stated that the city did not follow proper procedures. She continued that the project was too high in height and needs to have a precise plan. She stated that all documentation was submitted with impacts and attorney statements. She stated that Mr. Gong said he would lose his views with proposed changes. Ms. Adams went over the California laws that govern ADUs and related infrastructure.

Ms. Freeze made her rebuttal. She stated that given California laws do not allow for discretionary review of ADUs. She stated that all that is before the Council is the garage and the ADU is not within the scope.

Members of the public were allowed to speak at this time.

Joe Buck stated that city staff should have addressed the possibility of limiting the height of construction for single-housing buildings, and implored that changes need to be made and supported efforts to avoid permits in the future that will not be allowed.

Sarah Wachtfogel stated that an approval of this plan would affect the view of her parents' home negatively.

A member of the public stated that he was not against ADUs but was against the negative impact that the construction would cause.

Kathryn Dunican supported the Planning Commission's decision to not uphold the project. She stated that it was not about the ADU but that Torrance has not followed the right process to approve the project. She stated that there are still ways to show local control even with state laws.

Judy Brunetti detailed the problems with the flagging and outlining. She added there is no ocean view but it can be attained by building a second story on the garage. She implored that it should not obstruct the views of others. She stated that the city should not have to allow these types of developments and that there are ways to work within the law and rules. She disagreed with the project.

Deputy City Attorney Jennifer Guerrero detailed the differences and position of separating from the ADU and garage for each party.

A member of the public named Anika stated that the problems with the project would cause negative consequences for the neighborhood and that anyone's property could have this happen.

A member of the public named Marjorie detailed her issues with the building and that in the overlay there are certain rules that need to be enforced.

Michelle Wachtfogel disagreed with the project and elaborated on the bad precedent this would set if allowed.

A member of the public stated that this was a trojan horse and that the ADU was the trick. She continued that the city needed to review how ADUs were allowed so that people do not keep taking advantage.

A member of the public requested that the project be denied and reminded the owners of the amount of money spent and consider buying another house with a view.

Chris Cordovash stated that approving this would lead to more houses building up and blocking views.

A member of the public stated that the garage plans would have a negative effect on the community.

Jason Coles stated that this project would become a problem for the community and the current views, as they would become obstructed. He requested the denial of the project.

Libby Spatz stated that this garage was that was being considered was not the one that is being built and that the one that would be built should not be allowed.

Mark Shrader stated that there were people who have wanted the second story but were those did not happen. He continued that the procedures did not seem to be in place to deny this when it should be denied. He added that these additions obstruct the views of neighbors.

Lauren Cotner stated that this was fraudulent because the project owners were saying one thing and doing another.

Councilmember Lewis and Community Development Director Michelle Ramirez discussed the plan on the garage and the given height allowed. They overviewed in what ways the view, light, air, and privacy impacts could be reduced.

Mayor Kalani stated she was not comfortable approving of something without a precise plan.

Councilmember Sheikh stated that he did not see a silhouette. He requested the owners representation to recap their goal. Ms. Freeze elaborated on the project requests. Councilmember Sheikh and Ms. Freeze overviewed the decision of the Planning Commission. Councilmember Sheikh recommended to submit the project and make it straightforward. Community Development Director Ramirez recounted the plans that the project owners were trying to do, and stated that the ADU would not be stopped from being built if they submitted the garage and Planning Commission approved it. Councilmember Sheikh stated that this project was not helping in the fight for educating the public on state laws.

Councilmember Gerson and Ms. Freeze discussed the exemption and all requirements that were given. Community Development Director explained how requirements being met still meant that exemptions were being given. She also overviewed the precise plan process. Councilmember Gerson stated that there is much confusion through this process and that he would not overrule the Planning Commission.

Councilmember Sheikh stressed that working with the community was crucial and suggested to the project owner to do that.

MOTION: Councilmember Lewis moved to close the public hearing. Councilmember Gerson seconded the motion. The motion carried by a vote of 4-0 with Councilmember Kartsonis and Lieu recused.

MOTION: Councilmember Lewis moved to deny the appeal without prejudice. Councilmember Gerson seconded the motion.

The City Council went to recess at 9:14 p.m. The City Council returned from recess at 9:21 p.m.

The motion carried by a vote of 4-0 with Councilmembers Kartsonis and Lieu recused.

Councilmembers Kartsonis and Lieu returned to the City Council meeting at 9:22 p.m.

10. ADMINISTRATIVE MATTERS

10A. ADOPT RESOLUTION APPROVING THE MURAL APPLICATION BY CTC GROUP AT THE DOUBLETREE BY HILTON TORRANCE SOUTH BAY AND APPROVE THE INDEMNIFICATION AGREEMENT FOR MURAL ARTWORK

Recommendation of the Cultural Arts Commission and the Community Services Director that City Council:

1. Adopt a RESOLUTION (Mural #2026-00002) approving the recommendation of the Cultural Arts Commission for a public art mural application on property located within the Hawthorne Boulevard Corridor Specific Plan - Del Amo Business Sub-District One (H-DA1 Zone) at the DoubleTree Hilton Torrance South Bay, 21333 Hawthorne Boulevard and setting forth conditions of approval for the mural; and
2. Approve the Indemnification Agreement for Mural Artwork or a substantially similar agreement in a form approved by the City Attorney.

Culture Services Manager Monica Harte introduced the item to the City Council using slides.

Members of the public spoke.

Councilmember Lewis, Robert Vargas, and Cultural Services Manager Harte discussed the contract with Justin Herbert and the long-term plans for the mural.

Councilmember Sheikh and Deputy City Attorney Guerrero discussed any potential consequences for the city if something happens to the player.

City Clerk Poirier read the number and title for Resolution No. 2026-75 A RESOLUTION OF THE CITY COUNCIL OF THE CITY OF TORRANCE, CALIFORNIA, APPROVING A RECOMMENDATION OF THE CULTURAL ARTS COMMISSION OF A PUBLIC ART MURAL APPLICATION AS PROVIDED FOR IN DIVISION 9, CHAPTER 11, ARTICLE 11 OF THE TORRANCE MUNICIPAL CODE ON PROPERTY LOCATED WITHIN THE HAWTHORNE BOULEVARD CORRIDOR SPECIFIC PLAN-DEL AMO BUSINESS SUB-DISTRICT ONE (H-DA1 ZONE) AT 21333 HAWTHORNE BOULEVARD.

MOTION: Councilmember Gerson moved to adopt Resolution No. 2026-75. Councilmember Kartsonis seconded the motion. The motion carried by a vote of 6-0.

11. **AGENCY AGENDAS** – None Scheduled.

12. **CITY COUNCIL ORAL COMMUNICATIONS**

No members of the public spoke.

Councilmember Gerson, Councilmember Kartsonis, Councilmember Lieu, Councilmember Lewis, Councilmember Sheikh and Mayor Kalani spoke.

13. **CLOSED SESSION**

Considered earlier, see page 1. The City Council returned to closed session at 10:00 p.m. The City Council returned from closed session at 11:43 p.m.

14. **ADJOURNMENT**

MOTION: Councilmember Kartsonis moved to adjourn the City Council meeting at 11:44 p.m. to Tuesday, August 18, 2026, at 5:00 p.m. for Closed Session in the LeRoy J. Jackson Council Chamber. Councilmember Gerson seconded the motion. The motion carried by a vote of 5-1 with Councilmember Sheikh voting no.

Attest:

for Rebecca Poirier
City Clerk of the City of Torrance

Mayor of the City of Torrance

Approved on September 15, 2026